Master Guide – UK Savoury Snacks Case Study (from zero to interview-ready)

Read this top to bottom once. Then use Part 7 (numbers), Part 8 (questions) and Part 10 (quiz) to practise. Files you need open: `PepsiCo_Savoury_Case_Study_Deck.pptx` and `Savoury_Snacks_Analysis_Workbook.xlsx`.

Study plan (3 days, ~2 hours a day)

Day	Do this	Goal
1	Parts 1–4 (basics, metrics, brief, data)	Understand every word in the deck
2	Parts 5–6 (how the analysis was done + what to say per slide); click through the workbook	Explain *how* and *why* for each number
3	Parts 7–10 (numbers, questions, quiz); present the deck out loud twice, timed (12–15 min)	Answer any question calmly

Part 1 – Business basics (no prior knowledge needed)

PepsiCo sells drinks (Pepsi) and snacks. In the UK snacks business it is the market leader (in this data: 36.9% of sales).

The category: *Savoury Snacks* = crisps, tortilla chips, nuts, popcorn, crackers etc.

How the category is organised (from broad to detailed):

```
Category  →  Segment  →  Sub-segment     →  Brand       →  Product (SKU)
Savoury      Crisps      Potato Crisps      CoastalVale     "Salt & Vinegar 6-pack"
```

I analysed at **sub-segment** level (e.g. Potato Crisps, Nuts & Seeds, Crackers) because the segment names in the data are messy.

Pack formats (how the product is sold):

Pack	What it is	Typical occasion
Single / Grab / Standard	One small bag	Impulse, lunch, on-the-go
Multipack (small / medium / large)	Several small bags in one pack (e.g. 6 x 25g)	Lunchboxes, family weekly shop
Sharing	One big bag (e.g. 150g)	Sharing at home, parties, TV night

Retailers (customers): the shops PepsiCo sells through – Escora Retail, Saintbury Stores, Morees Markets, Asdaria Supermarkets, Acadia Grocers.

Store formats / channels:

Format in data	Meaning	My channel
LARGE FORMAT	Big supermarket	In-store
SMALL FORMAT	Convenience store	In-store
E-COMMERCE	A supermarket's website (e.g. Escora.com)	Online
PURE PLAY	Online-only retailer (no shops) – **Acadia Grocers**	Online

Supplier vs brand vs private label: a *supplier* is the manufacturer (PepsiCo, Valley Trail Foods…). A *brand* is the name on the pack (CoastalVale). *Private label* = the retailer's own brand.

Why the brief cares about e-commerce: online shopping is growing, baskets are bigger and planned, and there is no physical shelf – so winning online needs different tactics (search ranking, bundles, multipacks).

Part 2 – The metrics, explained with tiny examples

Metric	Formula	Example	How to read it
Value sales	£ through the till	£1,077m	Size
Units	Number of items sold	–	A 6-pack = 1 unit
Price per unit	Value ÷ Units	£1.82	Price level
Growth %	This year ÷ last year − 1	1,077 ÷ 1,065 − 1 = **+1.2%**	Momentum
Share	PepsiCo £ ÷ market £	397.6 ÷ 1,077.4 = **36.9%**	Strength vs competitors
Share change (pts)	Share TY − share YA	36.9% − 37.8% = **−0.9 pts**	Winning or losing. Use *points*, not %
Mix	Item £ ÷ total £	Online 183.6 ÷ 1,077.4 = **17%**	Importance
Contribution to growth	Item £ change ÷ total £ change	Online +£10.1m ÷ total +£12.4m = **82%**	Who drives growth
Index	A ÷ B × 100	52% ÷ 41% × 100 = **127**	100 = same; >100 = more; <100 = less
Online index	Item's share of online sales ÷ its share of in-store sales × 100	Large multipack 6.9% ÷ 3.0% = **228**	Sells 2.3x more (relatively) online
Fair share index	PepsiCo share in a pack ÷ PepsiCo share of that whole sub-segment × 100	20.1% ÷ 46.4% = **43**	<80 = PepsiCo is under-represented = **gap**
£ headroom	(Fair share − actual share) × cell sales	(46.4% − 20.1%) × £162.9m = **£42.9m**	Size of the prize (not a forecast)
Penetration	Buyers ÷ all shoppers	40 of 100 shoppers buy → 40%	How MANY buy
AWOP (Average Weight of Purchase)	Sales ÷ buyers = frequency × spend per trip	8 trips × £2.50 = £20 per buyer	How MUCH each buyer spends
Basket penetration	Baskets containing item ÷ all baskets	2,450 ÷ 5,000 = **49%**	Share of trips that include it
Co-purchase %	% of buyers of A who also bought B	80% of nuts buyers bought sharing crisps	Bundle potential

The one formula to remember:

```
Sales = Shoppers × Penetration × AWOP          (AWOP = Frequency × Spend per trip)
```

Every recommendation grows either **penetration** (more people buy) or **AWOP** (each buyer spends more).

Why "pts" not "%" for share change: share going from 37.8% to 36.9% is −0.9 *points*. Saying "−2.4%" (relative change) confuses leaders.

Part 3 – The brief, decoded

Who you are: channel analyst, PepsiCo UK e-commerce.

What they want:

1. **Top focus categories/brands** for all retailers → *where to play* (Q1)
2. **Pack & sub-segment gaps vs competitors** → *whitespace* (Q2)
3. **Basket differences by channel** → *how online is different* (Q3)
4. **Cross-category / cross-brand deals** → *bundles* (Q4)
5. **Clear actions for Acadia Grocers** → *one customer plan*
6. **7–10 slides, clear visuals, prioritised recommendations, stated assumptions**

What they score: structure, how you interrogate data, a clear commercial story – *not* one right answer.

Part 4 – The data in one page

Tab	One row =	Used for
Name mapping (actually the *sales data*)	One product, at one retailer & store format, in one week. 1,011,594 rows, 2024 wk 1–52 + 2025 wk 1–47	Q1, Q2, Acadia
Demographic Data	Shopper count for a group (life stage / age / mission) in a channel. Totals 12,000 in-store, 8,000 online	Who shops online
Basket_bands	Number of baskets in a value band (<£20, £20–60, >£60) per retailer. Each retailer = 1,000 baskets	Q3
CSN_metrics	Online vs offline baskets with Canned Nuts & Snacks (2 rows)	Q3, AWOP proxy
Basket_Combination_Data	% of buyers of X who also bought Y (7 rows)	Q4

The biggest limitation: the sales data has **no buyer counts**, so true penetration and AWOP can't be calculated → use share/growth and basket data as proxies, and *say so*.

Part 5 – How the analysis was done, step by step (as YOU would explain it)

Step 1 – Open and convert the file

The file came as `.xlsb` (binary Excel). Saved as `.xlsx` (Excel: *File → Save As → Excel Workbook*). Checked row counts and totals matched.

Step 2 – Check the data quality (EDA)

Check	Found	Did
Missing values	Flavour 7,385; Number of packs 3,186	Kept – not needed
Duplicates	1,600 rows worth £700	Kept – no impact
Zero sales	17% of rows = £0	Excluded only from price per unit
Odd store format	'Unallocated' £5.5k	Removed
Messy segments	'Private Label' used as a segment	Used sub-segment
No channel column	–	Created Online / In-store

In Excel: filters on each column (*Data → Filter*), `COUNTBLANK`, *Remove Duplicates* preview, pivot of value by store format.

Step 3 – Choose the comparison period (key decision)

2025 data stops at **week 47**. Weeks 48–52 are Christmas (week 51 ≈ £33m vs ~£23m normal).

- Wrong: 2025 (47 weeks) vs 2024 (52 weeks) = **−10.3%** (fake decline)
- Right: **2025 wk 1–47 (TY) vs 2024 wk 1–47 (YA) = +1.2%**

In Excel: add a column `Period = IF(WEEK<=47, IF(YEAR=2025,"TY","YA"), "Exclude")`.

Step 4 – Add the channel

```
Channel = IF(OR(Format="E-COMMERCE",Format="PURE PLAY"),"Online","In-store")
```

Step 5 – Summarise 1 million rows (PivotTable)

Insert → PivotTable → Rows: Period, Customer, Store format, Channel, Supplier, Brand, Segment, Sub segment, Pack, Sub pack → Values: Sum of Value, Sum of Units → *Design → Report Layout → Tabular, Repeat all labels, no subtotals* → copy as values into the `Data` tab (8,491 rows). Totals still reconcile (TY £1,077.4m, YA £1,065.0m).

Step 6 – Build each analysis table with SUMIFS

Example – PepsiCo sales in Potato Crisps this year:

```
=SUMIFS(Data!K:K, Data!A:A,"TY", Data!H:H,"POTATO CRISPS", Data!E:E,"PepsiCo")
```

Then: Growth `=TY/YA-1` · Share `=PepsiCo/Market` · Share change `=(ShareTY-ShareYA)*100` · Contribution `=(TY-YA)/(TotalTY-TotalYA)`.

Step 7 – The analyses (what each tab answers)

Workbook tab	Question	Headline result
1_Market	How is the market and PepsiCo doing, by channel and retailer?	Market +1.2%; online +5.8% = 82% of growth; PepsiCo −0.9 pts
2_SubSegment	Where does growth come from?	Potato Crisps −£12.9m; growth in Crackers, Bread Snacks, Nuts (PepsiCo 0–7%)
4_PackFormat	Which packs grow, where is PepsiCo weak, what sells online?	Sharing 38% of market, PepsiCo 25.6%; multipacks over-trade online
5_Whitespace	Which sub-segment × pack is PepsiCo's biggest gap?	Potato Crisps Sharing: £162.9m, PepsiCo 20.1% vs 46.4% → £42.9m
6_Online_Gaps	Is PepsiCo weaker online than in-store?	£2.5m (Tortilla Sharing, Nuts)
7_Acadia	What's different at Acadia?	PepsiCo 24.8% vs 38.6% elsewhere online → £4.2m
8_Shopper_Basket	How are online shoppers and baskets different?	Families, main shop, 62% baskets > £60, CSN 49% vs 23%
9_CrossBuy	What is bought together?	80% of nuts buyers buy sharing crisps
10_Opportunities	What first?	Score = impact 50% + ease 30% + fit 20%

Step 8 – Size the gaps (worked example)

Potato Crisps Sharing: market £162.9m; PepsiCo share 20.1%; PepsiCo's share of all Potato Crisps 46.4%.

- Fair share index = 20.1 ÷ 46.4 × 100 = **43** (< 80 → gap)
- Headroom = (46.4% − 20.1%) × £162.9m = 26.3% × £162.9m = **£42.9m**
- Say: *"This is headroom if PepsiCo performed in sharing as it does in crisps overall – not a forecast."*

Step 9 – Prioritise

Each action scored 1–5 on **Impact**, **Ease**, **Fit** → `Score = 0.5×Impact + 0.3×Ease + 0.2×Fit` Example: Potato Crisps Sharing = 0.5×5 + 0.3×3 + 0.2×5 = **4.4 → High**.

Part 6 – What to say on each slide (≈1 minute each)

Slide 1 – Title. "I looked at where PepsiCo can grow penetration and AWOP in e-commerce, with a plan for Acadia Grocers. Everything comes from one Excel workbook."

Slide 2 – Approach. "Five steps: data received – 1 million weekly sales rows; cleaned – 2025 stops at week 47, so I compare weeks 1–47 like-for-like and define online as e-commerce plus pure play; summarised in Excel; analysed; sized and prioritised. Key terms are on the slide – penetration is how many buy, AWOP is how much each buyer spends."

Slide 3 – Data check. "Six checks; none changes the totals materially. The data is sanitised, so I focus on relative gaps."

Slide 4 – Market. "The market is flat, +1.2%. Online grew 5.8% and delivered 82% of the growth. PepsiCo has 36.9% share but lost 0.9 points in both channels. Acadia is small – £30m – but the fastest-growing retailer at +15.5%, and PepsiCo's weakest share at 24.8%."

Slide 5 – Sub-segments. "PepsiCo's core, Potato Crisps, lost £12.9m. About £20m of growth came from Crackers, Bread Snacks, Nuts and F&V crisps – where PepsiCo has 0–7% share. So PepsiCo is missing where shoppers are moving."

Slide 6 – Packs. "Sharing is 38% of the market and growing 10% online – but PepsiCo has only 25.6% and is priced 18% above the market. Multipacks sell up to 2.3x more online, and PepsiCo leads them – that's our online AWOP lever."

Slide 7 – Biggest gaps. "The single biggest gap: Potato Crisps Sharing – £163m, PepsiCo only 20% versus 46% in crisps overall. Closing to fair share is £42.9m headroom. Nuts and Crackers are portfolio gaps."

Slide 8 – Online shopper. "Online shoppers are families doing the weekly shop – 79% main shop vs 43% in-store. 62% of online baskets are over £60. They're twice as likely to buy nuts and snacks and spend 1.5x more – bigger packs and bundles work here."

Slide 9 – Cross-buy. "8 in 10 nuts buyers also buy sharing crisps – a ready-made bundle. PepsiCo brands are already bought together 40–55% of the time – mix-and-match multibuys."

Slide 10 – Acadia. "Acadia grows 15.5%, PepsiCo there only 4.6%. PepsiCo share 24.8% vs 38.6% at other online retailers. Acadia shoppers buy far more nuts and better-for-you snacks where PepsiCo is weak, and PepsiCo also trails in its own core – Tortilla −25 points. Matching other online retailers is ~£4.2m."

Slide 11 – Recommendations. "Start where PepsiCo already has brands and the gap is biggest: Sharing crisps and online multipacks. Pilot a nuts + sharing bundle at Acadia for 8 weeks with a control, built with their category team, then scale. Validate with panel data before entering crackers."

Part 7 – Numbers to memorise (the top 15)

#	Fact	Number
1	Market size TY (wk 1–47)	£1,077m, **+1.2%**
2	Online growth / share of growth	**+5.8%**, **82%**
3	Online share of market	**17%**
4	PepsiCo share / change	**36.9%**, **−0.9 pts**
5	Potato Crisps change	**−£12.9m** (−2.9%), PepsiCo 46.4%
6	Growth where PepsiCo < 10% share	**~£20m**
7	Crackers growth / PepsiCo share	**+17.4%**, **0%**
8	Sharing: % of market / PepsiCo share	**38%**, **25.6%**
9	PepsiCo Sharing price index	**118**
10	Potato Crisps Sharing cell / PepsiCo share / headroom	**£163m**, **20%**, **£42.9m**
11	Online baskets > £60	**62%** (convenience 1%)
12	CSN basket penetration online vs offline	**49% vs 23%** (2.1x)
13	Nuts buyers also buying sharing crisps	**80%**
14	Acadia growth / PepsiCo share there vs other online	**+15.5%**, **24.8% vs 38.6%**
15	Acadia headroom	**~£4.2m**

Part 8 – Interview questions with model answers

About the method

1. *Why weeks 1–47?* – 2025 ends at week 47; including Christmas weeks only in 2024 shows a fake −10% decline. Like-for-like gives +1.2%.
2. *How did you measure penetration without buyer data?* – I couldn't directly. I used value share and growth as proxies, plus CSN basket penetration and demographics. I'd validate with a shopper panel (e.g. Kantar).
3. *What's AWOP?* – Average spend per buyer over a period = frequency × spend per trip.
4. *Why sub-segment, not segment?* – Segments are inconsistent ('Private Label' is a segment; Snack Mix sits in two).
5. *How did you handle 1 million rows?* – PivotTable to 8,491 rows, then SUMIFS tables. Every number traceable.
6. *Is the £42.9m real money?* – It's headroom to fair share over 47 weeks, not a forecast. Realistic capture is a fraction – e.g. closing a quarter of the gap ≈ £10m.
7. *Why fair share vs PepsiCo's own sub-segment share?* – It compares PepsiCo to itself, so it isolates *pack* gaps, not categories PepsiCo doesn't play in.

About the findings

8. *Biggest single insight?* – PepsiCo is under-represented where growth is: sharing packs, nuts, adjacencies and the fastest-growing online retailer.
9. *Why is PepsiCo weak in sharing?* – Two hypotheses: range (fewer sharing SKUs) and price (18% premium). Next step: test price-pack architecture.
10. *Why online for AWOP?* – Online is the planned weekly shop: bigger baskets (62% > £60), families, and nuts/snacks in 49% of baskets with 1.5x spend.
11. *Why Acadia if it's only £30m?* – It's growing 15.5% and PepsiCo is weakest there; it's also a good test-and-learn partner before scaling online.
12. *Why not recommend entering Crackers first?* – PepsiCo has no brand there; high cost and risk. Start where existing brands can win quickly; build the crackers case in parallel.

Challenges (stay calm, agree then add)

13. *"Isn't the data sanitised – can we trust it?"* – Yes, so I focus on relative gaps and direction, which are robust.
14. *"Your scores are subjective."* – They are judgement inputs; the workbook lets you change weights and see the ranking update.
15. *"Couldn't the cross-buy just be coincidence?"* – Possibly; without a base rate I can't compute affinity. A pilot with a control group answers that.
16. *"What would you do with more time/data?"* – Panel data for true penetration/AWOP, price elasticity, promo data, Acadia search-ranking data.
17. *"How would you measure success?"* – PepsiCo share in Potato Crisps Sharing, online AWOP (£ per basket), Acadia share, new-buyer count.
18. *"Which stakeholders do you need?"* – Brand (range), Revenue Management (price-pack), E-com team (search, bundles), Acadia customer team.

Part 9 – GREAT5 in one line each

- **Growth** – turned data patterns into hypotheses; clear on limits and next learning.
- **Relationships** – Acadia plan built *with* the retailer; owners across teams.
- **Execution** – 1m rows → 11 slides; every action has £, owner, KPI, timing.
- **Agility** – messy data handled with documented decisions and proxies.
- **Thinking** – avoided the −10% trap; shopper view, not only sales. (Details and STAR stories: `GREAT5_Interview_Prep.md`.)

Part 10 – Self-test quiz (answers below – cover them first)

1. What does an index of 127 mean?
2. Market TY £1,077m, YA £1,065m – growth?
3. PepsiCo share went 37.8% → 36.9%. How do you say the change?
4. Fair share index for a pack where PepsiCo has 30% and 60% across the sub-segment?
5. Headroom if that pack is worth £50m?
6. Penetration vs AWOP – which does a bigger multipack mainly grow?
7. Which channel delivered 82% of growth?
8. Why exclude weeks 48–52?
9. What % of online baskets are over £60?
10. PepsiCo share at Acadia vs other online retailers?

Answers: 1) 27% more than average/benchmark · 2) +1.2% · 3) "down 0.9 points" · 4) 30 ÷ 60 × 100 = 50 → gap · 5) (60% − 30%) × £50m = £15m · 6) AWOP · 7) Online · 8) 2025 has no data for them; Christmas would distort · 9) 62% · 10) 24.8% vs 38.6%

Part 11 – Final rehearsal checklist

- [ ] Name and date on slide 1
- [ ] Can explain penetration, AWOP, share pts, index, fair share in one sentence each
- [ ] Can show any slide's number in the workbook (source tab is on every slide)
- [ ] Presented out loud twice, 12–15 minutes
- [ ] Ready for the 18 questions in Part 8
- [ ] Two GREAT5 stories rehearsed (Thinking + Execution)
- [ ] Closing line ready: *"Start with Sharing crisps and online multipacks, pilot at Acadia, validate, then scale."*